

Chapter 173-2

Slap—

Liang Xinhe's hand slammed on the table again, causing the bowls and plates to shake and clatter.

The private room was deathly quiet. Liang Xinran's breathing seemed to freeze. She looked up at Liang Xinhe, and only after a moment did she say: "I... I..."

"You what." Liang Xinhe sneered. "I actually believed you when you said entering the entertainment industry was to find something you liked doing. What a waste that I helped you with all my heart. Big Brother didn't want you to do it, but I protected you. I treated you like a sister, and you?"

Liang Xinran froze, and tears began streaming down her face.

Liang Xinhe glanced at her sideways: "Big Brother was right. You came back just to compete."

"Compete for what?" Liang Xinran said aggrievedly. "What could I possibly compete for by entering the entertainment industry? The family business belongs to you and Big Brother. I've never had any designs on it. I know Mom and Dad feel guilty toward me and want to compensate me, but I don't want to see you all unhappy because of me. I've already moved out, and I can support myself. I already had a management contract before. I'm just continuing the life I had before. What did I do wrong?"

After speaking through tears, Liang Xinran raised her hand to wipe her tears and turned around to pretend to be strong, but her shoulders kept heaving—she was obviously crying.

Liang Xinhe's heart softened at her words, and for a moment he didn't know what to do.

Liang Xinran sniffled. "I know I'm not worthy of the Liang family. The education you all received from childhood is different from mine. My family was poor, and I could only rely on myself. I never thought about doing anything at the Liang family. But all these years, I just wanted my parents. What did I do wrong? I finally managed to add some shine to my broken life. I can finally stop going hungry. I can finally leave that small village and come to a big city. This was the path I was already fighting desperately to walk. How did it suddenly become me competing?"

Liang Xinran smiled bitterly: "Do I have to leave Haizhou and return to that life without any hope for it to be right? I don't understand."

Liang Xinhe was momentarily speechless.

Liang Xinran sighed softly: "I so wish you were all just ordinary office workers. I just want a family, that's all. But now nothing is simple, and it seems like I can't do anything. If you think it will only end when I return to where I came from, then I'll just go back."

Liang Xinran sat back down, turned around, picked up her spoon to eat, and lowered her eyes.

Though her voice was choked with sobs, she forced herself to appear strong: "I'll explain to Mom and Dad. I won't involve you. As for the entertainment industry, I won't do it anymore. I'll cancel my Weibo account too. In the future... I'll go back home to farm."

Liang Xinhe suddenly panicked: "That's not what I meant."

"I understand everything now." Liang Xinran swallowed her food but choked on it, looking pitiful and miserable. She said: "I really, truly won't appear before any of you again in the future, or even in Haizhou. My life will probably just have to end in that small village. This is my fate. I accept it."

Liang Xinhe suddenly didn't know what to say.

He had come to confront Liang Xinran, but because of these few sentences from her, all his anger dissipated and he couldn't say anything.

After a long while, Liang Xinhe finally asked: "It really wasn't you?"

"I have no idea what happened." Liang Xinran wiped her tears. "If you want to say it was me, then fine, it was me. Even if I say it wasn't, you won't believe me anyway."

Liang Xinhe: "....."

Liang Xinhe frowned, then answered a phone call. After hanging up, he said awkwardly: "Then you eat first. I'll go investigate."

After Liang Xinhe left, Liang Xinran spat out what she was chewing into the trash can, picked up her phone to check the hot search, and frowned when she saw the top few trending topics. She immediately switched to another number and called Zhang Yangning.

The call connected quickly. It was noisy on the other end.

Liang Xinran said angrily: "What are you doing? Who told you to leak the information to the media? Didn't I tell you? Wait until I say to leak it before leaking!"

Zhang Yangning's voice was lazy, sounding like he had been drinking too much. "Babe, what are you angry about? It wasn't me who leaked it."

Liang Xinran: "Why don't you just drink yourself to death."

Liang Xinran lit a cigarette, and blue-gray smoke dispersed before her eyes.

"How could I die?" Zhang Yangning chuckled. "You've seen today's hot search, right? It wasn't me."

"Then how did it suddenly get exposed? I already told you, Liang Xinzhou is keeping a close eye on me. The previous matter almost gave him something to hold against me. He can't find out about my relationship with you, otherwise we're both finished." Liang Xinran was furious. "Have you forgotten how you lost your job?"

"Bad luck." Zhang Yangning gritted his teeth at the memory, scoffing lightly. "How long are you going to be afraid of them?"

"I don't know." Liang Xinran said. "Liang Xinzhou is very vigilant right now. I entered the entertainment industry precisely to make him let his guard down. By the way, you said today's incident wasn't your doing—then who was it?"

Besides her, who else wanted to ruin Liang Shi's reputation?

"The one who acted alongside Liang Shi." Zhang Yangning chuckled. "I just... did a little tampering."

Liang Xinran: "....."

Zhang Yangning laughed even more brazenly: "That idiot fell for it. Don't worry, you just need to play your part well at the Liang family. You don't know anything anyway. Even if they keep investigating, they won't trace it back to you."

Liang Xinran froze for a moment, then threatened: "It better be that way."